

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

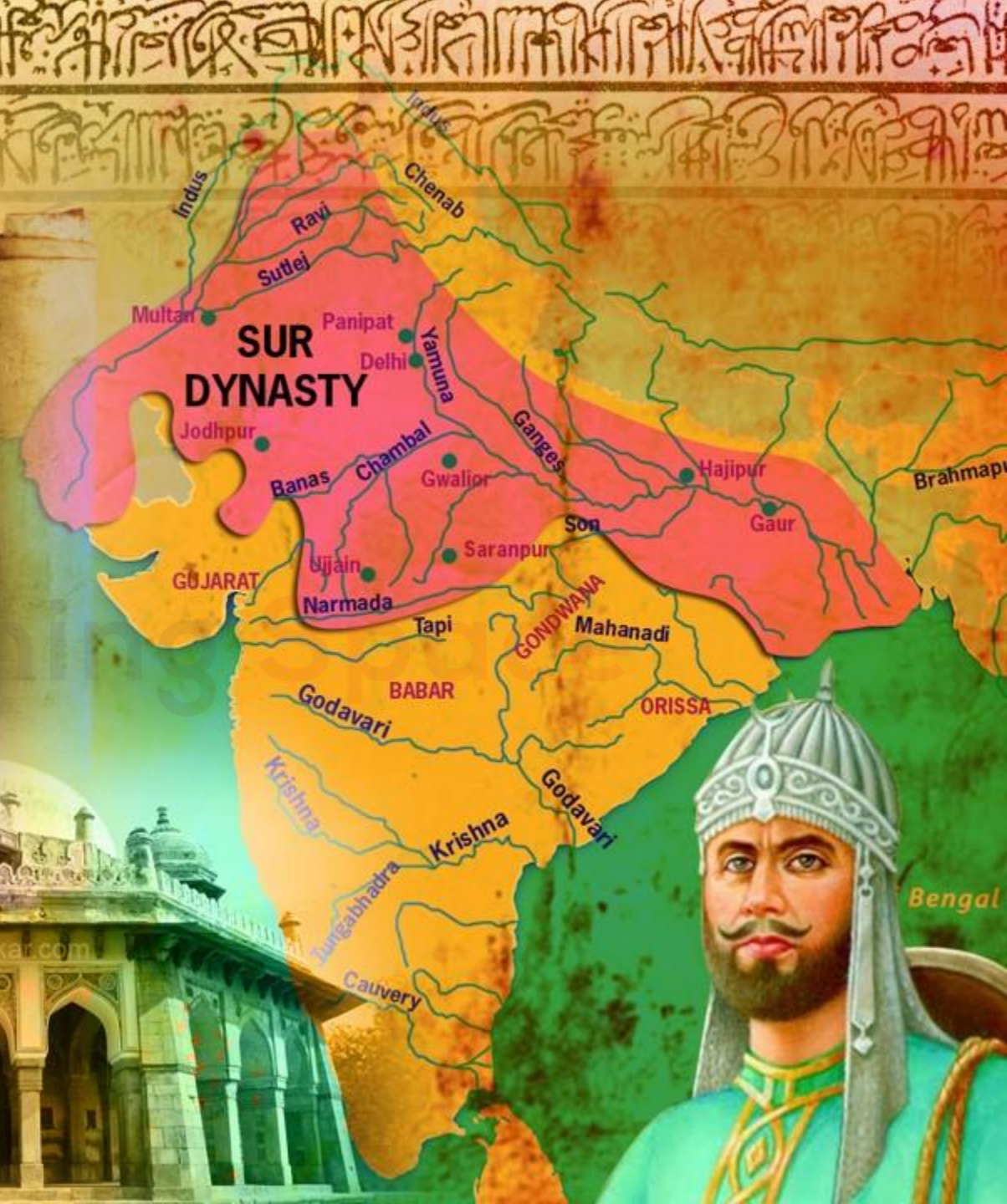


MODULE - 22

SUR DYNASTY
SHER SHAH SURI



SUR DYNASTY



SUR DYNASTY

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

INTRODUCTION

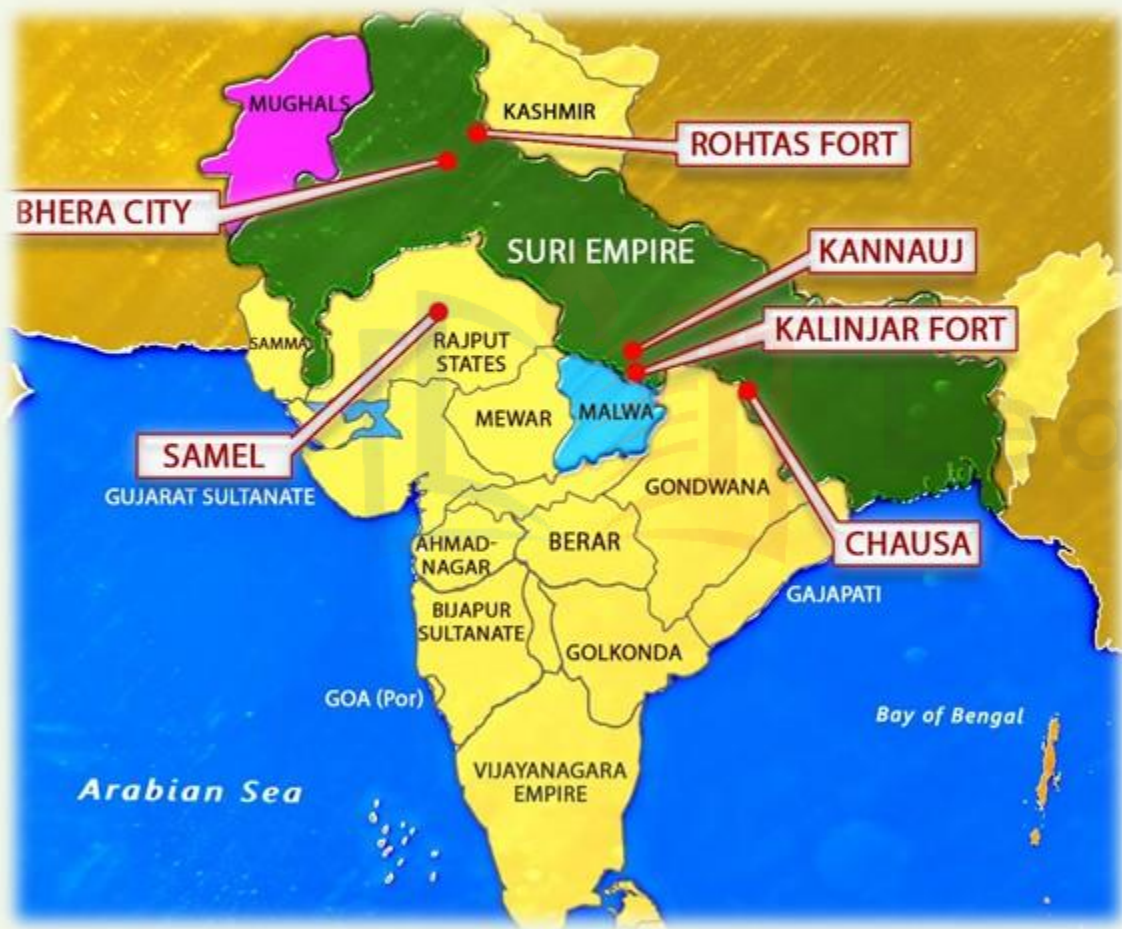


- 1 Sher Shah Suri (1486–1545 AD) Founder of the Sur dynasty and also the second Afghan Empire (after the Lodhis) whose original name was Farid.

- 2 He was the son of Hasan Khan, a jagirdar of Sasaram in South Bihar (Jaunpur).
- 3 Later, Farid served under the Afghan governor of Bihar, Bahar Khan Lohani, who gave him the title Sher Khan for his bravery (as he killed a tiger).
- 4 He very effectively managed the jagir of his father and also acquired great military and administrative skills. He gradually increased his influence and defeated Sultan Mahmud Shah of Bengal (Battle of Surajgarh) and emerged as the most powerful Afghan military commander in the eastern provinces.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

INTRODUCTION

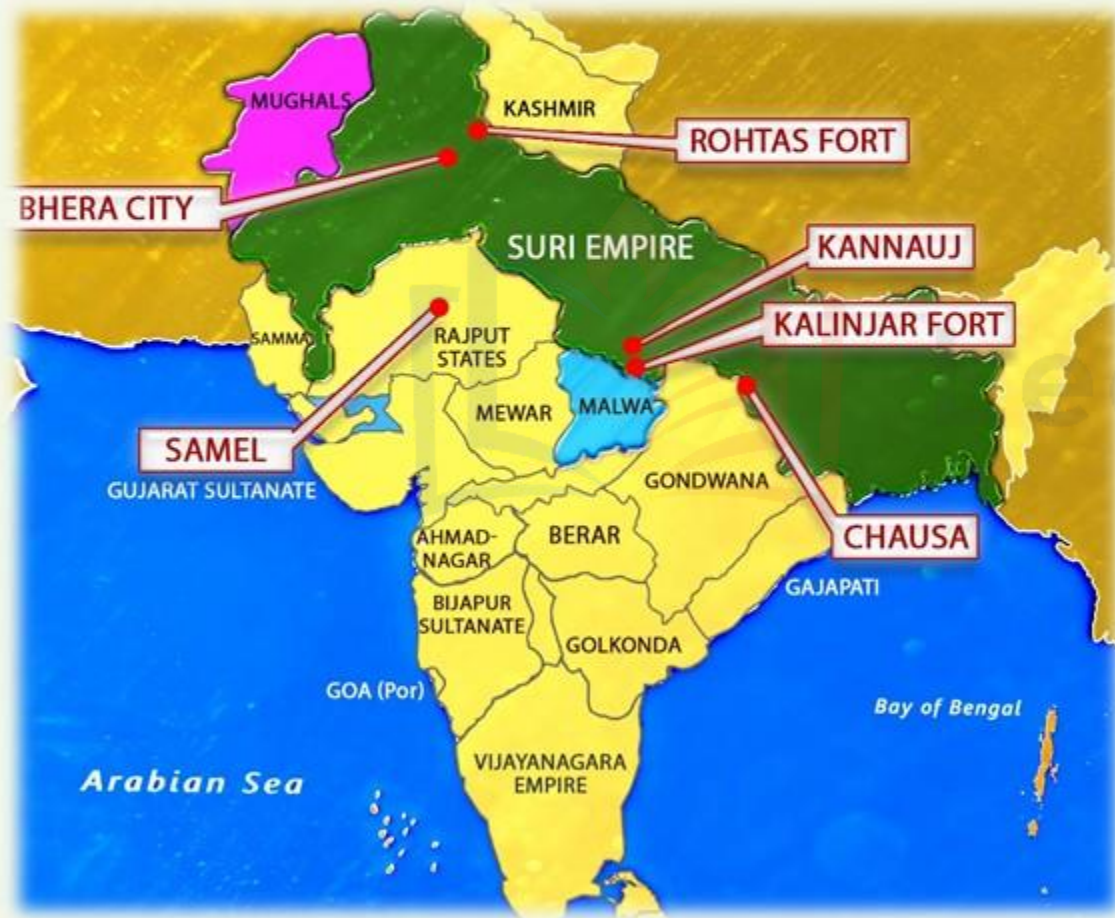


- 5** This brought him in conflict with Mughal emperor Humayun and he adopted the title of Sher Shah after defeating Humayun in the **Battle Of Chausa**, thus declaring himself as an independent king.
- 6** He defeated Humayun again in the **Battle Of Kannauj** and proclaimed himself as Emperor of Hindustan at the age of 54.
- 7** After expelling Humayun, he started consolidating his position in northern and eastern India. He defeated and **conquered Malwa** in 1542 AD, which was followed by Chanderi.

SUR DYNASTY

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INTRODUCTION



- 8** In Rajasthan he led campaigns against Marwar, Ranthambhore, Nagor, Ajmer, Jodhpur, and Bikaner.
- 9** **Battle of Samel** : He defeated Maldeo in the famous Battle of Samel around Ajmer (1544 AD). He defeated rebellious Afghans in Bengal and by 1545 AD, he had established himself as the supreme ruler from Sindh and Punjab to the whole of Rajputana in the west and Bengal in the east.
- 10** His last campaign was against Kalinjar (Bundelkhand), in which he succeeded but died from an accidental explosion of gun powder in 1545 AD.



MUGHALS

KASHMIR

ROHTAS FORT

BHERA CITY

SURI EMPIRE

KANNAUJ

SAMMA

RAJPUT STATES

KALINJAR FORT

MEWAR

MALWA

SAMEL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA

CHAUSA

AHMAD-NAGAR

BERAR

GAJAPATI

BIJAPUR SULTANATE

GOLKONDA

GOA (Por)

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER - ABOUT SHER SHAH SURI



1 Sher Shah, even though a pious Muslim, adopted a tolerant attitude towards other religions. He employed Hindus in important offices.

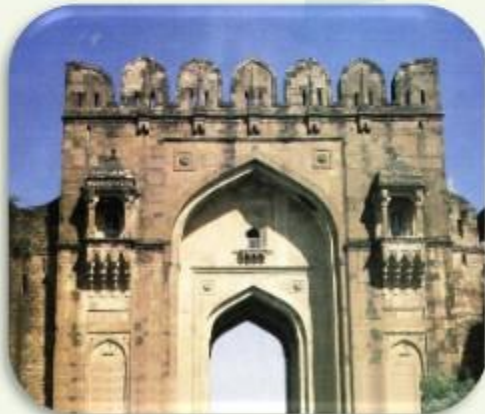
2 He was also a patron of art and architecture and built a new city on the banks of the river Yamuna near Delhi.

3 He built the Purana Qila (Old Fort), Sher Mandal, an octagonal building inside the Purana Qila complex, which later served as the library of Humayun, and his own mausoleum at Sasaram, which is considered as one of the master pieces of Indian architecture.



SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER - ABOUT SHER SHAH SURI



- 4 He also built the Rohtas Fort (now a UNESCO World Heritage Site in Pakistan), and the Sher Shah Suri Masjid, in Patna.
- 5 He built a new city, Bhera of modern day Pakistan, in 1545 AD
- 6 Sher Shah also patronised learned men. Malik Mohammad Jaisi completed his Padmavat during his reign.
- 7 Famous historian, Abbas Khan Sarwani, wrote the *Tarikh-i-Shershahi* during his reign.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

DEATH OF SHER SHAH SURI



- 1 He was succeeded by his son Islam Shah (Jalal Khan), who had to face a number of conflicts with his brother Adil Khan, and many Afghan nobles.
- 2 Sher Shah Suri died in 1553 AD and the Afghan empire was substantially weakened.
- 3 The Sur domains were partitioned among relatives of Sher Shah (Punjab, Agra, Delhi, Bihar and eastern region).

NOTE

Punjab was taken by Sikander Sur who was later defeated by Humayun. Humayun thus gradually captured his lost kingdom

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

SHER SHAH'S ADMINISTRATION (1540-1545 AD)



- 1 Although his rule lasted for only five years, he organized a brilliant administrative system which served as inspiration to not only the Mughal administration but to the British too.

- 2 The empire was divided into forty seven sarkars.
 1. Chief Shiqdar (law and order)
 2. Chief Munsif (judge)were the two officers in charge of the administration in each sarkar.
- 3 Each sarkar was divided into several parganas.
 - Shiqdar (military officer)
 - Amil (land revenue)
 - Fotedar (treasurer) and
 - Karkuns (accountants)were in charge of the administration of each pargana.
- 4 Mauza (village) was lowest level of administration.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION UNDER SHER SHAH SURI



- 1 The land revenue administration was very well organized
- 2 Revenue officers were called Amils
- 3 Qanungo were the officials in charge of maintaining revenue records.
- 4 Sher Shah for the first time introduced a schedule of crop rates (*ray*).
- 5 He improved land revenue system by adopting *Zabti-i-har-sal* (land assessment every year) and classified all cultivable lands into three heads (good, middle, bad).

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION UNDER SHER SHAH SURI



- 6** Amils used to oversee the measurement of land under cultivation for determining state share. The state's share was one third of the average produce and it was paid in cash or crop.
- 7** Land was measured using Sikandari gaz.
- 8** Sher Shah introduced two documents:
 - 1) Patta (amount each peasant had to pay)
 - 2) Qabuliyat (Deed of agreement).

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

COINAGE



- 1 Sher Shah also introduced new copper coins called Dam.

NOTE: They were in circulation till 1835 AD.

- 2 He was also the first ruler to introduce silver Rupayia.
(1 Rupayia = 64 dams)

- 3 He had also introduced gold coin (Ashrafi/Mohur).

- 4 **NOTE**

- a) While the term Rupayia had previously been used as a generic term for any silver coin, during his rule the term 'Rupayia' came to be used as the name for a silver coin of a standard weight of 178 grains.
- b) Similarly, gold coins weighed 169 grains.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

ROADS AND REST HOUSES



- 1** Sher Shah also improved the communications by building roads, and called it to be arteries of the empire.
- 2** He laid four important highways. These were:
 - a) Sonargaon to Sind:
Note: In this he restored the old imperial road (the Grand Trunk road by Ashoka)
 - b) Agra to Burhampur.
 - c) Jodhpur to Chittor.
 - d) Lahore to Multan.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

ROADS AND REST HOUSES



- 3 He built Sarais (rest houses) at the distance of every eight kms on the highways for the convenience of the travellers.
- 4 Features of these Sarais :
 1. These sarais were fortified lodging where travellers could pass the night
 2. Travelers could keep their goods in safe custody with rooms designed for that purpose.
 3. Every Sarai had several watchmen under the control of a **shahna** (custodian).

5 NOTE:

Many of the sarais developed into market towns (**Qasbas**) to which peasants flocked to sell their produce and these sarais were also used as stages for the news service or **dak-chowki**

SUR DYNASTY

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

LAW AND ORDER ADMINISTRATION



- 1 One of the foremost contributions of Sher Shah was his re-establishment of law and order across the empire.
- 2 Police was efficiently reorganized and crime was less during his regime.
- 3 He dealt sternly with robbers and dacoits, and with zamindars who refused to pay land revenue or disobeyed the orders of the government.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

TRADE AND COMMERCE

1 Sher Shah also introduced other reforms to promote growth of trade and commerce.

2 In his empire, goods paid customs duty only at two places:

1. FIRST LEVEL

- a) Goods produced in Bengal or imported from outside paid customs duty at the border of 'Bengal and Bihar' at Sikrigali
- b) Goods coming from West and Central Asia paid customs duty at the Indus.

Note:

No one was allowed to levy customs at roads, ferries, or towns, or anywhere else.

2. SECOND LEVEL

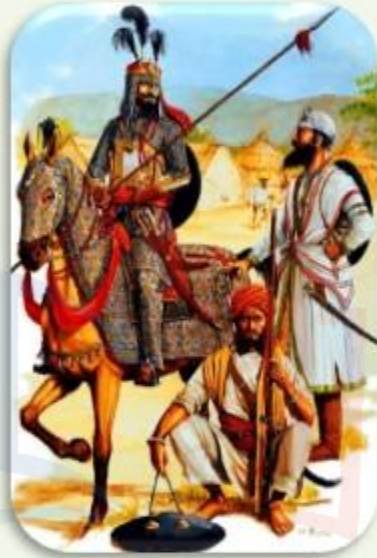
The duty was paid a second time at the time of sale.

3 He directed his Amirs to compel the people to treat merchants and travellers well in every way, and not to harm them at all. In fact, he made the local village headmen (muqaddams) and zamindars responsible for any loss that the merchant suffered on the roads.

SUR DYNASTY

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MILITARY ADMINISTRATION



- 1 The military administration was also efficiently reorganised and Sher Shah revived Alauddin's Chehra and Daggh system.
- 2 He personally supervised recruitment of soldiers and paid them directly.
- 3 He divided the army into
 - **Sawars** (Cavalry Division which served as linchpin of Military)
 - Elephant Division
 - Frontmen (infantry)
- 4 He maintained his personal royal force called **Khasa Kail**.

SUR DYNASTY (1540 AD - 1555 AD)

JUSTICE ADMINISTRATION



- 1 He placed considerable emphasis on justice and considered justice to be the most important of the religious duty.
- 2 He did not spare oppressors, whether they were high nobles, men of his own tribe or near relatives.
- 3 Qazis were appointed at different places for justice
- 4 Village panchayats and Zamindars dealt with civil cases at the local level.
- 5 Islam Shah(son of Sher Shah Suri) took a big step towards dispensation of justice as he codified the laws

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suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

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